

Arjun Gururajan

SOFTWARE ENGINEER III / BACKEND PLATFORMS & DISTRIBUTED SYSTEMS

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PROFILE

Backend and platform engineer with 10+ years across product and cloud systems. At Condé Nast, shaped newsletter subscription architecture, led design reviews, and mentored six engineers. Brings production AI integration to scalable, cost-efficient systems.

ARCHITECTURE & PLATFORM IMPACT

Newsletter subscription platform

2023 - Present

- Helped shape architecture for 50M+ subscriber records; built the core API and a downstream orchestrator, supporting peaks of ~400 requests/sec during major events such as the Met Gala.
- Advocated fewer services and simpler boundaries in architecture reviews. The full newsletter-backend overhaul cut costs by nearly 50%, including Kafka retirement and Node.js memory optimization.
- Built a scheduler running ~70 jobs/day of ~30K records each; optimized its runner to use roughly 180 MB of a 512 MB pod. Provisioned AWS with Terraform and deployed via GitHub Actions.
- Integrated a third-party Model Context Protocol (MCP) capability into the production subscription frontend and contributed to a chatbot.

Multi-brand content delivery

2022 - 2023

- Built a reusable Hapi backend for The New Yorker iOS app and RSS feeds; also built app notification preferences.

Reusable publishing & editorial systems

2019 - 2022

- Built the Handlebars library for The New Yorker flagship newsletters and integrated it with Copilot CMS; the library remains in use. Earlier contributed to a shared publishing monorepo serving ~40 brands.

EXPERIENCE

Condé Nast | Software Engineer III

2022 - Present

Condé Nast | Software Engineer II

2019 - 2022

Synamedia | Senior Software Engineer

2018 - 2019

OpenText | Software Engineer / Contractor

2014 - 2018

TECHNICAL DEPTH

Architecture: system design, distributed systems, high-throughput APIs, event-driven workflows, queueing

Applied AI: Model Context Protocol (MCP) integration, chatbot development

Backend & data: Node.js, JavaScript, Go, Hapi, Express, REST, GraphQL, MongoDB, SQL, Kafka / Confluent

Cloud & delivery: AWS (SQS, SNS, Lambda, EC2, S3, IAM), Terraform, GitHub Actions, Kubernetes

EDUCATION

M.E., Computer Science - University Visvesvaraya College of Engineering (UVCE), 2013 - 2015

B.E., Information Science - Channabasaveswara Institute of Technology, 2009 - 2013